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The Prospector

April 9, 1976

Sport Scene

By Robert Longoria

After Indiana upended Michigan in a humiliating showdown for the National Collegiate Athletic Association title, everyone expected for the college basketball season to be over with until next year. The fact is that it wasn't. The Pizza Hut Classic terminated last week and the Aloha Classic All-Star in Honolulu, Hawaii began yesterday and continues until tomorrow. Miner Basketball Coach Don Haskins has been given the duties of serving as one of the four coaches for the basketball tournament.

Haskins will be coaching the West squad of the four team tourney. Haskins has always had good credentials and this season was no exception—although the Miners had a setback in not reaching the NCAA play-offs. The UT El Paso basketball squad ended the season with a 19-7 record and ranked as one of the top defensive teams in the nation. Haskins career record is 296-103.

Gary Brewster, a 6-8 senior on the Miner squad who performed throughout the season with an ailing back, also was slated to attend the classic and serve on the West squad under Haskins, but surgery prevented him from entering.

Not only are the all-star classics underway in the college ranks, but basketball continues to make its debut on the pro circuit. The National Basketball Association's playoffs are in a couple of weeks. Boston and Golden State already have qualified for the playoffs, with Golden State being a favorite to repeat as NBA champions.

High school basketball will remain on the scene a few more weeks, although the state championships have already been concluded. A team of Russian high school all-stars will make their tour through this country and play high school all-stars from most states. They have a strong centerstanding at 7 feet. college basketball coming to an end of another season and professional basketball in high gear, basketball enthusiasts better

take advantage of the remaining games because it will be a long wait until next season. Probably the only way of witnessing any remaining games is through television.

About the only way to be sure that basketball season has come to an end is to await the start of the World Series in baseball.

Diamondmen open WAC

The UT El Paso baseball squad has already rid themselves of pre-conference blues after establishing a record of six wins against eight losses. Miner Baseball Coach Andy Cohen will once again go through painful experiences as Western Athletic Conference competition opens today.

The University of New Mexico will be the Miners first conference opponent today at Dudley field with the game being slated for 1 p.m. Action will resume on Saturday with a doubleheader starting at noon.

Conference competition opens today.

The three-game series will force the Miners ability to compete with WAC foes—a conference which boasts two of the top teams in the nation; Arizona and Arizona State. A team must really have it together to compete at their level. Toughness and confidence will be two elements

Jeff Hogan, will be asked by Cohen to pull through with another victory despite his ailing back. Powerful hitters Glen Villareal, who plays the third base position, and right fielder Terry Dillingham must continue to provide hitting power.

After the series ends with the Lobos, the Miners will hit the turf once again at Dudley field—this time an exhibition game against the El Paso Diablos. The game will be this Monday at 7 p.m.

Only time will tell how much caliber the baseball squad possesses. During pre-conference action, the Miners did not display awesome power. Probably the only thing needed is time—an item the Miners are running short of.

sports

Five women to compete in Arizona track meet

By Mike Brand

The girls track team will compete in the Arizona State university Track Classic, tomorrow with a small but versatile squad.

This is the first major meet of the season, and will see five girls competing for UT El Paso.

Alison Olsen will compete in the 100, 220, and 440 yard dashes. Nancy Berdecia will also be sprinting, as she is entered in 1440 and 880 yard runs.

Rosa Martinez will run the mile for the Minorettes, in which she finished third last week in a Las Cruces meet.

Le Ann Richel and Becqui Parsons are the lone field events

competitors for the team, and both are entered in the long jump.

The UT El Paso squad is small by comparative standards said by coach, Carol Ammerman, and that the teams to beat will be the larger ones.

"The University of New Mexico, Arizona, and Arizona State all have very large teams, and this depth gives them an advantage over the re over the rest of the schools," explained the coach.

The team has been working out since the beginning of March, and works out every day under the guidance of Ammerman and Assistant coach, Wayne Thornton.

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